

BULK API : Malformed action/metadata line [3], expected START_OBJECT but found [VALUE_STRING]

Asked 5 years, 11 months ago Modified 1 year, 3 months ago Viewed 31k times



Using Elasticsearch 5.5, getting the following error while posting this bulk request, unable to figure out what is wrong with the request.

28



```
"type": "illegal_argument_exception",
"reason": "Malformed action/metadata line [3], expected START_OBJECT but found [VALUE_STRING]"
```



POST http://localhost:9200/access_log_index/access_log/_bulk

```
    "geoip.country_name": "United States",
    "geoip.region_code": "NJ",
    "geoip.region_name": "New Jersey",
    "geoip.city": "Newark",
    "geoip.zip_code": 7102,
    "geoip.time_zone": "America/New_York",
    "geoip.latitude": 40.7355,
    "geoip.longitude": -74.1741,
    "geoip.metro_code": 501
  }
{ "index": { "_id": 12 } }
{
  "id": 12,
  "tenant_id": 682,
  "tenant_name": "kcc",
  "user.user_name": "k0772251",
  "access_date": "20170821",
  "access_time": "02:50:44.123+01:30",
  "operation_type": "launch_service",
  "remote_host": "qlsso.quicklaunchsso.com",
  "user_agent": "Mozilla/5.0 (Linux; Android 7.0; LGLS775 Build/NRD90U) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/56.0.2924.87 Mobile Safari/537.36",
  "browser": "",
  "device": "",
  "application.application_id": 2341,
  "application.application_name": "Gmail",
  "geoip.ip": "192.95.18.163",
  "geoip.country_code": "US",
  "geoip.country_name": "United States",
  "geoip.region_code": "NJ",
  "geoip.region_name": "New Jersey",
  "geoip.city": "Newark",
  "geoip.zip_code": 7102,
  "geoip.time_zone": "America/New_York",
  "geoip.latitude": 40.7355,
  "geoip.longitude": -74.1741,
  "geoip.metro_code": 501
}
```

elasticsearch

elasticsearch-bulk-api

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edited Aug 21, 2017 at 10:17



halfer

halfer 19.8k ● 17 ● 99 ● 186

asked Aug 21, 2017 at 8:19



balaji thiruvengadam

281 ● 1 ● 3 ● 3

3 Your documents must be on a single line, no newlines are allowed within them. – Val Aug 21, 2017 at 8:20

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– halfer Aug 21, 2017 at 10:17

4 Answers

Sorted by:

Highest score (default)



48



Your resource objects have to be specified on a single line like this

```
post /test322/type/_bulk
{ "index": {} }
{ "name": "Test1", "data": "This is my test data" }
{ "index": {} }
{ "name": "Test2", "data": "This is my test data2" }
```

Which seems really stupid and unintuitive I know since resources don't have to be on a single line when you create them using PUT or POST for non-bulk operations.

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answered Sep 7, 2018 at 15:15



Neutrino

Neutrino 8,358 ● 4 ● 55 ● 83

2 This saved me a few hours at least.. Thank you ;) – Rahul Ranjan Sep 24, 2018 at 7:22

6 Also, it expects a line end at the last. – anand Apr 17, 2019 at 21:26

2 That doesn't match an actual [example on Elastic](#), but then their documentation is — in places — not optimal. – Wayne Smallman Jul 27, 2019 at 14:39

2 This is such a bizarre API, the whole elasticsearch API seems to be written by data scientist rather than programmers... A less intuitive api is hard to find I think... – Operator Aug 29, 2021 at 16:14

2 @Operator This particular API simply supports `ndjson` rather than straight `json` - see [ndjson.org](#) – jtlz2 Jun 9, 2022 at 7:43

The following lines' format worked for me very well: **Action, metadata, resource**